MD. AKIL KHAN

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EDUCATION

Khulna University, Khulna, Bangladesh ku.ac.bd

B.Soc.Sc. in Mass Communication and Journalism *Graduation: December 2024*

CGPA: 3.53/4.00

Khulna University, Khulna, Bangladesh ku.ac.bd

M.Soc.Sc. in Mass Communication and Journalism *Graduation: June 2026*

CGPA: 3.63/4.00

Idaho State University, Pocatello, Idaho, United States isu.edu

MA in Communication

Attendance: Spring 2026

CGPA: 4.00/4.00

Oklahoma State University, Stillwater, Oklahoma, United States okstate.edu

MS in Mass Communications *Expected Graduation: May 2028*

CGPA: 0.00/4.00 (1st Semester Running)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCES

Research Interest: Health Advertising and Message Design, Behavioral Change, Persuasion, Social Media Campaigns, and Strategic Communication.

Manuscript Under Review

- Biswas, A., Sultana, B. C., Salman, S., Islam, A., **Khan, M. A.**, & Cooley, S. (2026). Breathing Through the Feed: A Pilot Study of HRV Biofeedback and Emotion Regulation During Exposure to Emotionally Charged Social Media Content. *PLOS Mental Health.* Manuscript under review.
- **Khan, M. A.**, Tomal, M. M. H. & Islam, M. (2026). Comments On vs Off: How Audiences Evaluate Corporate Crisis Apologies on Social Media. *Corporate Communications: An International Journal.* Manuscript under review.

Peer-Reviewed Publications

- **Khan, M. A.**, Islam, M. S., & Biswas, A. (2026). Environmental Journalism under Constraint: Literacy, Normative Pressures, and Institutional Gaps in Bangladesh. *Journalism Practice*. https://doi.org/10.1080/17512786.2026.2703611
- Biswas, A., **Khan, M. A.**, Ahammed, K., Ahmed, S., & Nobel, S. K. (2025). Mobilizing Information in Cancer News: How Bengali and English Newspapers Deliver Actionable Health Messages in Bangladesh. *News Research Journal*. https://doi.org/10.1177/30497841261467320

Peer-Reviewed Conference

- **Khan, M. A.,** Biswas, A., Ferdoushi, L., Sultana, N., Khan, R., & Hossain, M. S. (2026, November). *When Campaigns Move People: Message Presence, Health Beliefs, and Quit Intentions in South Asian Tobacco Control*. Accepted for Presentation at the National Communication Association 112th Annual Convention, New Orleans, LA, United States.
- **Khan, M. A.**, Ferdoushi, L., Sultana, N., & Biswas, A. (2026, November). *Numbers in Movement: Numeric Risk Framing in Health Advertising Messages, Perceived Personal Relevance, and the Role of Numeracy*. Accepted for Presentation at the National Communication Association 112th Annual Convention, New Orleans, LA, United States.
- **Khan, M. A.**, Biswas, A., Sultana, N., & Ferdoushi, L. (2026, November). *Moving Through the Feed: Rural Social Media Users' Reception of Anthropomorphic AI Health Characters and the Movement of Health Information in Bangladesh*. Accepted for Presentation at the National Communication Association 112th Annual Convention, New Orleans, LA, United States.
- Sakib, S. & **Khan, M. A.** (2026, March). *AI at the ballot: Deepfake campaigns, framing, and voter engagement — Evidence from South Asia*. Poster presented at the ISU Research and Creative Works Symposium, Pocatello, ID, United States.
- Sakib, S., Sharma, N., Bashar, K., Kabir, M. R., & **Khan, M. A.** (2026, March). *The credibility of social media political influencers and their impact on political consumption: Evidence from Bangladesh*. Paper presented at the AEJMC Midwinter Conference 2026, Norman, OK, United States.
- Kabir, M. R., Hasan, R., & **Khan, M. A.** (2026, March). *From self-branding to belonging: Political identity formation and narrative framing on social media*. Paper presented at the

AEJMC Midwinter Conference 2026, Norman, OK, United States.

- **Khan, M. A.**, Islam, M. S., & Biswas, A. (2025, November). *The State of Environmental Journalism in Bangladesh: Exploring Journalists' Literacy, Challenges, and Potential Solutions.* Paper presented at the National Communication Association 111th Annual Convention, Denver, CO, United States.
- Pinky, F. T., Biswas, A., Razib, M. H., Sultana, N., **Khan, M. A.**, & Ahmed, S. (2023). Framing Health News: A Comparative Analysis Between DC and LDC Countries. *The Canadian Communication Association Conference 2025*, Toronto, Ontario, Canada.

Research Projects

- Portrayal of teenage gangs in Bangladeshi media: A frame analysis. (2021 – 2024). Presented at the *2024 Southwest Symposium*, Texas State University, USA.

  Advisor: Farzana Tasnim Pinky, Assistant Professor, Khulna University.
  Role: *Research Assistant.*
- Social Media Addiction, Mental Health, and Academic Performance among Students in Bangladesh

  Advisor: Bezon Kumar, Assistant Professor of Economics, Rabindra University

  Role: *Research Assistant*

ACADEMIC/PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

National Communication Association (NCA)

Member *September 2026 – Present*

Ad Hoc Reviewer, Annual Convention — 2026

- Reviewed research submissions for the Environmental Communication and Political Communication Division

Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC)

Ad Hoc Reviewer, Annual Conference Paper Competition — 2026

- Reviewed research submissions for the Advertising Division, Communicating Science, Health, Environment, and Risk Division, and Political Communication Division.

School of Media & Strategic Communications Graduate Student Association (SMSC-GSA)

Member *August 2026 – Present*

WORK EXPERIENCE

School of Media & Strategic Communications cas.okstate.edu/media

Oklahoma State University

Graduate Teaching Assistant *August 2026 – Present*

Assisted Courses:

- SC 3693 Social Media Analytics (Supervised by Dr. Sumin Shin)
- SC 3383 Strategic Communications Management and Strategies (Supervised by Dr. Sumin Shin)
- MMJ 4393 Data Journalism (Supervised by Dr. Liu Benetta)

Department of Communication, Media and Persuasion isu.edu/cmp

Idaho State University

Graduate Research Assistant *January 2026 – May 2026*

Mass Communication and Journalism Discipline ku.ac.bd/mcj

Khulna University

Graduate Teaching Assistant *August 2025 – December 2025*

Assisted Courses:

- Research in Communication and Media (Part-II) (Supervised by Md. Shariful Islam)
- Introduction to Journalism: Sessional (Supervised by Md. Shariful Islam)
- Bangla Writing Skills: Sessional (Supervised by Md. Shariful Islam)

Teaching & Instructional Support:

- Led classes in the instructor's absence; prepared slides and facilitated discussions.
- Graded assignments/exams with rubrics; provided written feedback.
- Assisted with NVivo Training: coding, theme development, qualitative data management, and visualization.
- Proctored midterms/finals; enforced academic integrity.
- Assisted in course curriculum development.

Rumor Scanner rumorscanner.com

Fact Checker *April 2024 – September 2024*

- Fact-checked 30+ pieces of misinformation and rumors on social media during the recent political crisis in Bangladesh.
- Contributed to an investigative fact-check report on 60+ missing persons nationwide within a week.
- Published 100+ Fact-Check Stories on politics, environment, health, education, international issues, etc.

BRAC Youth Platform brac.net/program/youth-platform

Mentor *December 2023 – October 2025*

- Mentored three community project initiatives from scratch to the final stage of implementation.
- These projects were solely focused on climate change, education, sustainable solutions, and social entrepreneurship.

Youth School for Social Entrepreneurs (YSSE) ysseglobal.org

Management Trainee – Communication Intern *August 2023 – March 2024*

- Worked in the Social Media Management Team, was the Leader of the LinkedIn team, and managed the organization's LinkedIn Page
- Gained 1,000+ followers on LinkedIn; created digital content for Social Media
- Got promoted to Management Trainee within five months

BK School of Research (BKSR) bksr.bd2015@gmail.com

Research Assistant *April 2021 – May 2023*

Odommo Bangla (MCJ Discipline's News Portal), Khulna University odommobangla.com

Contributor *January 2021 – December 2024*

Newsg24 (National News Portal), Dhaka newsg24.com

Khulna University Correspondent *September 2022 – January 2023*

Sadhin24 (National News Portal), Dhaka sadhin24.com

University Correspondent and MoJo *June 2020 – February 2021*

PROJECTS

Coastal Voices

Co-Founder & Communication Lead *2024 – Present*

- US Department of State and TechCamp-funded project.
- Working on the capacity building of coastal community journalists in the Khulna region regarding media literacy and environmental journalism.

Project Ujjibon

Co-Founder & Communication Head *2023 – Present*

- Working on the capacity building of climate migrant students of the Khulna region.
- In the first phase, 40 secondary school students were part of the project
- Got the Amra Notun Changemakers' Award – 2024 and secured a place in the top five projects list all over the country

TRAINING

Institutional Quality Assurance Cell, Khulna University *August 2025*

- Training on Teaching Assistantship

Deutsche Welle Akademie

- Misinformation and Fact-checking: Media Information Literacy *December 2022*
- Digital Storytelling *December 2022*
- Communication and Technique on Digital Rights/Safety
    - Media Laws, and Media Ethics *December 2020*

MRDI (Media Resources Development Initiative) *November 2024*

- Fact-Checking & Digital Hygiene

AFP Digital Courses *October 2024*

- Verifying climate claims

HerWILL (Partnering with University of North Georgia) *December 2023*

- Cross-Cultural Communication Program (Online)

Datascape Research and Consultancy Limited *December 2023*

- Qualitative Research Methodology and Data Analysis using NVivo

Dataful *December 2023*

- Basics of Data Journalism

Lead Academy *October 2023*

- Certified Volunteerism: Connect, Engage and Develop

BRAC Youth Platform *August 2023*

- Amra Notun Changemaker's Programme 2023

International Fact-Checking Network (IFCN) *June 2023*

- Fact-Checking Fundamentals with IFCN

CONDUCTED WORKSHOPS

Differentiating Between AI-Generated & Original Content

Reflective Teens *May 2025*

- Trained 30 secondary school students on how to differentiate between AI-generated & Original Content on social media.

Clearing the Fog: Combating Climate Misinformation in the Digital Age

Coastal Voices *November 2024*

- Trained 12 coastal community journalists and 8 university students, all eager to tackle the challenges of climate and environmental misinformation.

Fact-checking Session to Fight Misinformation and Rumors

BRAC Youth Platform *August 2024*

- Trained 25-30 young fact-checkers who are working on debunking and tackling misinformation on social media during the crisis nationwide.

Basic Fact-checking Training for Journalists

Khulna University Journalists' Association *March 2024*

- Trained 20 young journalists on the process of fact-checking while reporting daily or investigative reports

Leadership and a Good Leader's Role

Project Ujjibon *November 2023*

- Trained 40 climate migrant secondary school students about leadership and how they can contribute to society by bringing change.

LEADERSHIP & EXTRACURRICULAR EXPERIENCE

US Department of State

Exchange Alumnus *2024 – Present*

- Participated in TechCamp Bangladesh 2024, received training on addressing disinformation, enhanced knowledge of media ethics, and received media technology training. Designed a project, ranked in the top five, and got selected for funding

Amra Notun Network

Alumni & Young Changemaker *2023 – Present*

- Got training in social work, leadership, and entrepreneurship. Participated in several social initiatives.

Khulna University Journalists' Association

Office Secretary - General Member *2020 – 2023*

- Involved in campus journalism, wrote press releases, generated news stories, and organized workshops and competitions.

Khulna University Research Society

Executive Member *2022 – 2023*

- Worked with the member recruitment team. Organized workshops and competitions.

Bangladesh National Cadet Corps (BNCC)

Cadet *2017 – 2019*

- Was selected and joined the winter camp with the Bangladesh Army.

Badhan Khulna University (Voluntary Organization)

Blood Donor *2020 – Present*

- Donated blood 4 times.

AWARDS & HONORS

- Conference & Research Travel Grant (**$1,000**) – ISU Graduate School *2026*
- Project Funding **($1000)** by UNICEF & US Department of State *2025*
- **Khulna University Day Award – 2024** for extracurricular activities *2024*

- Project Funding **($4980)** by the US Department of State *2024*
- **Amra Notun Young Changemakers' Award 2024**, *BRAC Youth Platform* *2023*
- Three **Khulna University Academic Scholarships** in three consecutive undergraduate academic years for academic performance *2020-2023*
- **Upazila Round Winner** in Exploring Creative Talent *2014*
- **Best Student Award** by Moheshkhali Model High School *2013*

SKILLS & TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

Research Expertise: Experimental Survey Design, Content Analysis, and In-depth Interviews.

Software Expertise: R Programming Language, Qualtrics, NVivo, and MS Office

Professional Expertise: Fact-checking, Project Management, Graphic Design, Photography, Social Media Management.

LANGUAGE SKILLS

- Bengali: Bilingual Proficiency.
- English: Working Proficiency
  - IELTS: Overall Band Score 7.0 (L 8.0, R 7.5, W 6.5, S 6.5), 16 November 2024.